NOAH
Neonatal Oral Antibiotics at Home

NHS
Greater Glasgow and Clyde

Neonatal Oral Antibiotics at Home



Why does my baby need antibiotics?

Your baby is having antibiotics because they have an infection, or because doctors think they might be at risk of infection. Your baby will need antibiotics for at least 36-48 hours.
If the tests show no infection, your baby may stop the antibiotics. However, your baby might need more oral (by mouth) or intravenous (through a drip) antibiotics.

The doctors will explain what will happen next.

This leaflet explains what neonatal infection is and what signs to watch for when you go home. If you have any questions after reading this, please ask a member of the medical team.





What is early onset neonatal infection?

Early onset neonatal infection is when a baby gets an infection in the first 72 hours of life. Newborn babies are more likely to get infections because their immune system (which helps fight illness) is still developing. The signs of infection can be hard to spot but, if not treated they can lead to serious illness or even be life-threatening. This is why babies who may have an infection, or who are at risk of infection, are started on antibiotics quickly.

The following things can make your baby more likely to get an infection:

- The waters breaking more than 24 hours before the baby is born
- The mother having a high temperature (over 38°C) or needing antibiotics during labour
- Bacteria in the birth canal (like Group B streptococcus)
- The mother has had a baby with a Group B streptococcus infection before
- The baby being born early (before 37 weeks)
- Signs of infection in the newborn baby

What are the signs and symptoms of infection?

If you are worried about your baby while they are on antibiotics, please sget medical advice (contact details below).

These are the signs to look out for:

- Unusual behaviour (like crying a lot or being very quiet)
- Being floppy
- Baby is having trouble feeding or is being sick a lot
- A temperature that is too low (below 36°C) or too high (above 38°C)
- Fast breathing or grunting noises
- A change in the colour of the skin

If you need help urgently, call ☎ **999** or go to the Emergency Department.

What does it mean for my baby to complete a course of oral antibiotics?

Your baby has already had antibiotics through a drip (intravenous) and is doing well.

However, they need to continue with antibiotics by mouth (oral antibiotics) because there are still concerns about infection. After the oral antibiotics, your baby will have completed a 7-day course of antibiotics.



once you are home the Neonatal Hospital at Home Team will visit your baby each day during the course of their oral antibiotics to check on their progress and to ask of if you have any concerns.

How should I give oral antibiotics to my baby?

Before you go home, a member of staff will show you how to give the oral antibiotic and answer any questions you may have. For full information about giving medicine to babies, please look at

this Medicines for Children booklet.

What should I do if my baby is sick (vomits)?

- If your baby is sick less than 30 minutes after taking the medicine, give them the same dose again
- If your baby is sick more than 30 minutes after taking the medicine, don't give another dose. Wait until the next normal dose
- If your baby is sick again, ask for medical advice



What are the risks of antibiotic treatment?

The antibiotic your baby will take (Amoxicillin) is safe for newborn babies. It is safe even if the mother has a penicillin allergy. Some babies may have short-term side effects, such as diarrhoea or vomiting. If this happens, please ask for medical advice.

You can read more about 🌐 **Amoxicillin for bacterial infections here**.

How can I get medical advice while my baby is being treated with oral antibiotics?

If you have any worries or need advice while your baby is taking antibiotics, please ask for medical advice via the contact details below:

Between 8am and 8pm please contact:
Hospital at Home Team
☎ **07866 957 495**

Outwith these hours you can contact:
Princess Royal Maternity:
☎ **0141 451 5222**

Royal Alexandra Hospital:
☎ **0141 314 7035**

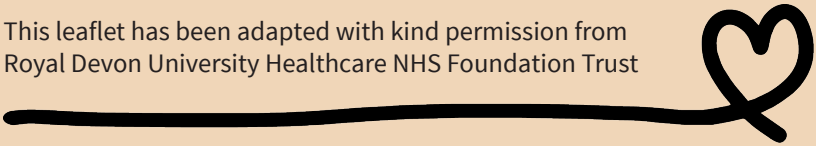
Royal Hospital for Children:
☎ **0141 452 4929**

Sources of Information:

1. **NICE guidelines on early onset neonatal infection**
2. **NHS website for pregnancy and caring for baby**
3. **Medicines for Children website**

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This leaflet has been adapted with kind permission from Royal Devon University Healthcare NHS Foundation Trust



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